



# Automation Audit Checklist

## for Small Digital Businesses

A practical, action-focused checklist to identify repetitive tasks, spot no-code automation opportunities, and prioritise workflows that save time, reduce admin, and support revenue growth.

### Inside this checklist

Step-by-step audit process, workflow examples, tool ideas, scoring matrix, and implementation plan.

# Executive Summary

Small digital businesses lose time when routine tasks stay trapped in inboxes, spreadsheets, manual copy-and-paste, and disconnected tools. An automation audit is a structured review of everyday work so you can find bottlenecks, spot repetitive tasks, and choose practical no-code fixes before buying more software.

This DigiTech Lifestyle checklist gives founders, creators, affiliate marketers, bloggers, coaches, and service providers a clear audit process across content, email, admin, sales, social media, and customer support. It is designed to be completed quickly, then repeated monthly as the business grows.

The goal is not to automate everything. The goal is to automate the right things first: tasks that repeat often, waste time, create errors, delay follow-up, or block revenue-producing work.

## Key Planning Data Points

| Data point               | Recommended target                          | Why it matters                                                                     |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Audit speed</b>       | Complete the first pass in 30 to 60 minutes | A fast first pass reduces overwhelm and exposes obvious automation wins.           |
| <b>Workflow priority</b> | Start with 3 high-impact workflows          | Small starts help you test, improve, and avoid breaking customer-facing processes. |
| <b>Human review</b>      | Review 100% of public-facing messages       | Protects trust, brand voice, customer experience, and compliance.                  |

## How to Use This Checklist

- Print or duplicate this PDF before each audit.
- Pick one business area first if you are short on time.
- Score each workflow using the prioritisation matrix near the end.
- Automate one workflow, test it, document it, then move to the next.

# 1. Automation Audit Principles

## Start with outcomes

Define what the workflow should improve: speed, accuracy, follow-up, publishing consistency, lead capture, or customer satisfaction.

## Map the current process

Write down the real steps, including manual checks, approvals, waiting time, and tool switching.

## Find repeatable triggers

Look for actions that happen after a form is submitted, an email arrives, a sale happens, a task is completed, or content is published.

## Keep humans in the loop

Use automation for routing, reminders, drafts, tagging, reporting, and data movement. Keep judgment, refunds, complaints, legal issues, and sensitive replies under human review.

## Document what works

A good automation becomes a mini operating system: trigger, tools, steps, owner, test rule, and fallback plan.

## Recommended No-Code Toolkit Stack

| Function             | Simple setup                                                              |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Workflow automation  | Zapier, Make, Pabbly Connect, n8n, or native app automations              |
| Content and planning | Notion, Google Docs, Airtable, Trello, ClickUp, Canva, ChatGPT            |
| Email and CRM        | Kit, Mailchimp, Brevo, HubSpot, ActiveCampaign, Google Sheets             |
| Social media         | Buffer, Metricool, Publer, Later, Canva scheduler                         |
| Support and forms    | Tally, Typeform, Google Forms, Jotform, Help Scout, Zendesk, Gmail labels |

## 2. Step-by-Step Automation Audit Process

### Step 1: Choose the audit area

Select content, email, admin, sales, social media, or customer support. Do not audit the whole business at once unless you already have a clear process map.

### Step 2: List every recurring task

Write down tasks that happen daily, weekly, monthly, after each customer action, or after each piece of content is created.

### Step 3: Capture triggers and inputs

Identify what starts the task: email received, form submitted, file uploaded, sale completed, booking made, comment posted, invoice due, or lead magnet downloaded.

### Step 4: Measure time and friction

Estimate how long the task takes, how often it happens, what goes wrong, and where the delay or duplication appears.

### Step 5: Decide the automation type

Choose whether the task needs a reminder, routing rule, data sync, content repurposing, email sequence, dashboard update, or draft response.

### Step 6: Score and prioritise

Use the scoring matrix to rank workflows by frequency, time saved, error risk, revenue impact, and ease of setup.

### Step 7: Build a small test

Create one simple automation, test it on a low-risk task, check the output, and document the fallback step.

### Step 8: Review monthly

Keep the workflow if it saves time and improves quality. Adjust or delete it if it creates confusion, errors, or extra admin.

## 3. How to Identify Repetitive Tasks

Use these questions during the audit. Any task with three or more yes answers is a strong automation candidate.

- ☐ Does this task happen more than once per week?
- ☐ Does it require copying data between apps?
- ☐ Does it use the same message, template, or checklist each time?
- ☐ Does a delay cause lost sales, missed follow-up, or customer frustration?
- ☐ Can the trigger be clearly defined?
- ☐ Can the output be checked quickly by a human?
- ☐ Would a saved template or rule reduce mistakes?
- ☐ Does the task distract you from revenue-generating work?

### Common Automation Signals

| Signal                         | What it usually means                         | Possible automation                                  |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Same reply sent repeatedly     | Support or sales questions are predictable    | FAQ bank, saved replies, AI-assisted draft responses |
| Manual lead follow-up          | New leads are not entering a sequence quickly | Form to CRM/email list plus welcome sequence         |
| Content stuck after publishing | Repurposing is not systemised                 | Blog to social post checklist and scheduler          |
| Spreadsheet copying            | Data is moving between tools by hand          | App-to-sheet sync, alerts, dashboard update          |

## 4. Audit Checklist Sections

### Content Workflow Checklist

- ☐ Topic ideas are stored in one backlog.
- ☐ Each article/video has a standard brief, outline, draft, edit, publish, and repurpose process.
- ☐ SEO titles, meta descriptions, image alt text, and internal links are checked before publishing.
- ☐ Published content is logged in a tracker with URL, category, CTA, and refresh date.
- ☐ One long-form asset is repurposed into at least 5 short assets.

### Email Workflow Checklist

- ☐ New subscribers automatically receive the correct lead magnet.
- ☐ Welcome emails are triggered without manual sending.
- ☐ Tags or segments show interest area, source, and buyer stage.
- ☐ Abandoned enquiries, carts, or bookings trigger follow-up reminders.
- ☐ Unsubscribes, bounces, and complaints are reviewed regularly.

### Admin Workflow Checklist

- ☐ Invoices, receipts, and order records are stored in the correct folder.
- ☐ Recurring tasks have reminders and owners.
- ☐ Files use consistent naming conventions.
- ☐ Meeting notes are converted into actions.
- ☐ Weekly dashboards summarise key business numbers.

## 5. Audit Checklist Sections Continued

### Sales Workflow Checklist

- ☐ Lead forms capture source, interest, budget, and next step.
- ☐ Every lead enters a follow-up sequence or pipeline.
- ☐ Sales questions are turned into FAQs and content ideas.
- ☐ Proposals, quotes, and invoices use templates.
- ☐ Lost leads are reviewed for objections and improvement opportunities.

### Social Media Workflow Checklist

- ☐ Posts are planned in batches instead of created randomly.
- ☐ Captions, hashtags, graphics, and links follow a reusable checklist.
- ☐ Published posts are tracked by platform and performance.
- ☐ Comments and DMs are triaged by urgency.
- ☐ High-performing posts are repurposed into blogs, emails, or videos.

### Customer Support Workflow Checklist

- ☐ Common questions are stored in an FAQ or knowledge base.
- ☐ Support emails are labelled by issue type.
- ☐ Refund, complaint, and technical issues have clear escalation rules.
- ☐ Reply templates include empathy, answer, next step, and close.
- ☐ Customer feedback is reviewed for product and content improvements.

## 6. No-Code Automation Ideas and Workflow Examples

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>Lead magnet delivery</b><br/> <b>Use:</b> Send a file instantly when someone fills a form.<br/> <b>Input:</b> Form submission, lead magnet URL, email tool.<br/> <b>Output:</b> Subscriber added, file delivered, tag applied.<br/> <b>Check:</b> Test with your own email.</p>  | <p><b>Blog repurposing checklist</b><br/> <b>Use:</b> Turn a published article into social and newsletter tasks.<br/> <b>Input:</b> Published URL, category, target platforms.<br/> <b>Output:</b> Task list for captions, graphics, email, and internal links.<br/> <b>Check:</b> Check links and brand voice.</p> |
| <p><b>Sales enquiry follow-up</b><br/> <b>Use:</b> Make sure new enquiries are never missed.<br/> <b>Input:</b> Contact form, CRM or spreadsheet, email template.<br/> <b>Output:</b> Lead logged, owner notified, follow-up email drafted.<br/> <b>Check:</b> Do not overpromise.</p> | <p><b>Customer FAQ capture</b><br/> <b>Use:</b> Turn repeated support questions into a knowledge base.<br/> <b>Input:</b> Support inbox labels, common questions.<br/> <b>Output:</b> FAQ draft, content ideas, saved replies.<br/> <b>Check:</b> Verify policy answers.</p>                                        |
| <p><b>Invoice reminder</b><br/> <b>Use:</b> Reduce missed admin deadlines.<br/> <b>Input:</b> Invoice dates, payment status, reminder rules.<br/> <b>Output:</b> Reminder sent to owner or customer.<br/> <b>Check:</b> Keep tone professional.</p>                                    | <p><b>Social comment triage</b><br/> <b>Use:</b> Separate urgent comments from general engagement.<br/> <b>Input:</b> Platform notifications, keywords, labels.<br/> <b>Output:</b> Priority list or alert.<br/> <b>Check:</b> Human reviews sensitive replies.</p>                                                 |
| <p><b>Weekly performance dashboard</b><br/> <b>Use:</b> Summarise business signals each week.<br/> <b>Input:</b> Traffic, leads, sales, email stats.<br/> <b>Output:</b> One-page weekly insight brief.<br/> <b>Check:</b> Separate data from opinion.</p>                             | <p><b>Content refresh alert</b><br/> <b>Use:</b> Identify content that needs updating.<br/> <b>Input:</b> Publish date, category, priority keyword.<br/> <b>Output:</b> Monthly refresh task.<br/> <b>Check:</b> Check current facts.</p>                                                                           |



## 7. Final Scoring Section: What to Automate First

Score each candidate workflow from 1 to 5 in each category. Add the total. Automate high-scoring workflows first, especially where time saved and revenue impact are strong and setup difficulty is low.

| Workflow candidate         | Frequency | Time saved | Error risk | Revenue impact | Ease | Total |
|----------------------------|-----------|------------|------------|----------------|------|-------|
| Lead magnet delivery       | /5        | /5         | /5         | /5             | /5   | /25   |
| Sales enquiry follow-up    | /5        | /5         | /5         | /5             | /5   | /25   |
| Blog repurposing checklist | /5        | /5         | /5         | /5             | /5   | /25   |
| Customer FAQ capture       | /5        | /5         | /5         | /5             | /5   | /25   |
| Invoice reminder           | /5        | /5         | /5         | /5             | /5   | /25   |
| Weekly dashboard           | /5        | /5         | /5         | /5             | /5   | /25   |
| Social media scheduling    | /5        | /5         | /5         | /5             | /5   | /25   |
| Content refresh alert      | /5        | /5         | /5         | /5             | /5   | /25   |

### Priority Rules

- 20-25 points: automate first. These workflows likely save time, reduce risk, or protect revenue.
- 14-19 points: schedule next. Improve the process first, then automate.
- 8-13 points: document only. A checklist or template may be enough.
- 0-7 points: leave manual for now. The task may be too rare, sensitive, or unclear.

## 8. 30-Day Implementation Plan

### Week 1: Audit and prioritise

- ☐ Choose one business area.
- ☐ List recurring tasks.
- ☐ Score each workflow.
- ☐ Pick the top three automation candidates.
- ☐ Write the current manual process.

### Week 2: Build the first automation

- ☐ Choose the simplest high-score workflow.
- ☐ Define trigger, action, owner, and fallback.
- ☐ Build the no-code automation.
- ☐ Run at least three test cases.
- ☐ Document the final workflow.

### Week 3: Connect to revenue or customer experience

- ☐ Add lead capture, follow-up, or customer support improvements.
- ☐ Check all public messages manually.
- ☐ Track time saved and errors avoided.
- ☐ Update templates and saved replies.
- ☐ Ask whether the automation improves the customer journey.

### Week 4: Review and scale

- ☐ Keep, improve, or delete each automation.
- ☐ Train a team member or VA using the SOP.
- ☐ Create a monthly automation review habit.
- ☐ Add one dashboard or reporting workflow.
- ☐ Build the next highest-scoring automation.

## 9. Ready-to-Use Prompts and SOP Template

### Repetitive task finder

Review this task list and identify which tasks are repetitive, rule-based, and suitable for no-code automation: [paste task list]. Return trigger, action, risk, and tool ideas.

### Workflow mapper

Turn this manual process into a clear workflow map: [paste process]. Include trigger, inputs, steps, outputs, owner, tools, failure points, and quality checks.

### Automation idea generator

Suggest no-code automation ideas for this business area: [content/email/admin/sales/social/support]. Keep ideas beginner-friendly and include tool options.

### Scoring assistant

Score these workflows from 1 to 5 for frequency, time saved, error risk, revenue impact, and ease of setup: [paste workflows]. Explain the top three priorities.

### SOP creator

Create an SOP for this automation: [describe automation]. Include purpose, trigger, tools, step-by-step process, testing checklist, owner, fallback plan, and review schedule.

## Automation SOP Template

Purpose: \_\_\_\_\_

Trigger: \_\_\_\_\_

Tools: \_\_\_\_\_

Inputs: \_\_\_\_\_

Steps: \_\_\_\_\_

Quality check: \_\_\_\_\_

Fallback if automation fails: \_\_\_\_\_

Owner: \_\_\_\_\_

Review frequency: \_\_\_\_\_

Last updated: \_\_\_\_\_

# 10. Governance, Quality, and Brand Protection

Automation should make the business more consistent, not less accountable. Use this quality gate before allowing any workflow to operate without close supervision.

- ☐ Is the trigger clear and reliable?
- ☐ Is the destination correct?
- ☐ Are customer-facing messages reviewed before launch?
- ☐ Does the workflow protect private data?
- ☐ Is there a human owner?
- ☐ Is there a fallback if the tool fails?
- ☐ Can you explain the automation to a beginner?
- ☐ Is the workflow documented in your operations hub?

## Final Word

The best automation system for a small digital business is simple, documented, and focused on outcomes. Start with one workflow that saves time or improves follow-up. Test it carefully. Then build a small library of reliable automations that support content creation, lead capture, sales, support, and admin without removing human judgment.

# Sources and Notes

This PDF is an original DigiTech Lifestyle checklist. The following sources informed general framing around automation audits, workflow readiness, small business AI automation, digital marketing checklists, and checklist-based PDF resources.

1. Automation Audit Checklist: <https://alltomate.com/resources/automation-audit-checklist/>
2. Resources & Downloads: <https://swiftcase.co.uk/resources/>
3. The Small Business AI Checklist: Everything You Need Before Your First Automation:  
<https://workbeaver.com/blog/the-small-business-ai-checklist-everything-you-need-before-your-first-automation>
4. The Ultimate Digital Marketing Checklist + PDF Template:  
<https://www.lianatech.com/resources/blog/the-ultimate-digital-marketing-checklist-pdf-template-fully-updated-for-2020.html>
5. The Complete Small Business Automation Checklist:  
<https://www.aryolabsai.com/the-complete-small-business-automation-checklist-50-tasks-you-can-automate-today.php>
6. Business Automation Checklist Guide | PDF: <https://www.scribd.com/document/885019459/30-Day-Business-Automation-Checklist>